by China and Pakistan. The AA was brought to the table as part of the Nationwide Ceasefire Agreement negotiated by the Myanmar government but that also collapsed post the coup of February 2021. The revised deadline set as 2021 had to be further revised to 2023. The manner in which the project was executed, including the bureaucratic and contractual delays on our side, with time and cost overruns did not compare favourably with China.

Something similar happened to another request made by Myanmar through Army channels. We had been continuously requesting the MA to take action against various Indian insurgent groups sheltering in Myanmar, opposite our states of Nagaland, Manipur and Mizoram. The MA said that they were trying their best but were hampered by the lack of proper roads in the area. Accordingly, they made a plan to develop five roads leading into the interiors, which would facilitate their movement and ability to launch operations. For each of the roads, they had proposed a set of plant equipment, with one 'set' to be deployed for the construction of each road. One such set as projected by them comprised two dozers, a motor grader, two compactors and five tipper trucks, about ten pieces of equipment per set. The MA had identified five roads to start with, so that meant a total of fifty vehicles in all. This request was made in late 2008, with a similar request to China for their border to the East. The proposal, after due deliberations at the embassy, was submitted through both the MEA and Defence Wing channels.

In early January 2009, we lost my father-in-law to lung cancer, although he had never smoked a single cigarette in his entire life. The Vice-President, Shri Mohammad Ansari, was scheduled to visit when Uma rang up to say that things were serious. Veena immediately left for India via Bangkok and I was

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